

Stefano Sangiovanni

Ph.D Candidate in Political Science • Milan, Italy

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EDUCATION

NASP Graduate School, University of Milan

October 2023 – Present

PhD Candidate in Political Science

Milan, Italy

- Supervisors: Prof. Andrea Ceron, Prof. Giovanna M. Invernizzi
- Thesis Title (Provisional): “The balance between positional and valence issues in party competition”
- Research Interests: Political Parties, Electoral Behavior, Quantitative Text Analysis, Survey Experiments, Computational Methods

Trinity College Dublin

January 2026 – April 2026

Visiting PhD Researcher

Dublin, Ireland

- Sponsor: Prof. Constantine Boussalis

University of Mannheim

April 2025 – May 2025

Visiting PhD Researcher

Mannheim, Germany

- Visiting Fellowship at the Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)

University of Milan

October 2020 – March 2023

Master's Degree in Administration and Public Policy, 110/110 with honours

Milan, Italy

- Thesis Title: “Communicating in times of crisis: a comparative analysis of school policy discourse in Italy and Great Britain during the covid-19 pandemic”

University of Milan-Bicocca

October 2017 – October 2020

Bachelor's Degree in Sociology

Milan, Italy

- Thesis Title: “Gender Representations in the Media: The Model of the Global Media Monitoring Project”

SUMMER, WINTER SCHOOLS & ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Adapters: Lightweight Machine Learning for Social Science Research, GESIS

June 2025

Adapter-based fine-tuning of LLMs in Python

Large Language Models for Political Scientists, SISP 2024

September 2024

Gained hands-on experience with LLMs for political science research using Python

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), University of Bologna

June 2024

Two-week summer school on computational methods, with competitive selection process

RECSM Winter Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

March 2023

Network Analysis and Visualization with R

RECSM Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

June 2022

Introduction to Python, Introduction to R, Survey Methodology and Survey Design

TEACHING & TUTORING

Teaching Assistant & Academic Tutoring

Italian Political System

A.Y. 2025/26

University of Milan, Italy

Public Policies

A.Y. 2025/26

University of Milan-Bicocca, Italy

Bachelor's Degree Course in Political Science

A.Y. 2023/24 – 2025/26

University of Milan, Italy

Master's Degree Course in Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs

A.Y. 2024/25

University of Milan, Italy

Guest Lectures

Political Sociology

A.Y. 2023/24 – 2024/25

BA in International Sciences and European Institutions, University of Milan

Course taught by Prof. Cristiano Vezzoni

Lecture: “Measuring Democracy: Theory and Practice” – [Lecture slides](#)

Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs

A.Y. 2024/25

Thesis Seminars for Master's students, University of Milan

Lecture: “How to plan a social sciences research design” – [Lecture slides](#)

Lecture: “Introduction to Qualitative Research” – [Lecture slides](#)

PUBLICATIONS, CONFERENCES & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Conferences & Seminar Presentations

- 2026** European Consortium of Political Research (ECPR), *Scheduled*, Kraków, 8-11 September 2026.
- 2026** European Political Science Society (EPSS), *Scheduled*, ICC Belfast, 18-20 June 2026.
- 2026** PolMeth Europe 2026, *Scheduled*, Trinity College Dublin, 14-15 May 2026.
- 2026** Quantitative and Computational Analysis of Text, Image and Video-as-Data (COMPTTEXT), *Scheduled*, Birmingham, 23-25 April 2026.
- 2025** BAGSS Workshop Computational Text Analysis in Party Research. *Economic Performance Indicators and Strategic Valence Choices*. University of Bamberg, 25–26 September 2025.
- 2025** Social Science Methodology Conference (RC33). *Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants' Satisfaction Across National and European Levels*. University of Naples, 22–25 September 2025 (with G. Celebrin).
- 2025** Italian Political Science Association (SISP). University of Naples, 4–6 September 2025.
- 2025** MetRiSP Workshop. *Methods for Political Science Research in the Age of Artificial Intelligence*. MetRiSP Network, 3 September 2025.
- 2025** Collegio Carlo Alberto Days. *When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns*. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.
- 2025** MZES-DVPW Methods of Political Science. *Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments*. University of Mannheim (with A. Ceron & G. M. Invernizzi).
- 2024** POLS PIRSS Seminar Series. *Analyzing Public Perceptions of Government Actions and Political Scandals Through Survey Experimental Designs*. University of Milan (with U. Platini).
- 2024** Italian Political Science Association (SISP). University of Trieste, 12–14 September 2024.
- 2024** Collegio Carlo Alberto Days. *Valence Theory and Political Scandals: A Proposal of a Conjoint Experiment*. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin.
- 2022** Jean Monnet Centres of Excellence. *European Emission Trading System: The Impact of EU-ETS on Costs and Benefits*. University of Milan (with A. Lombardi, M. Nascone & E. Rossoni).

Working Papers

Sangiovanni, S., Ceron, A., Invernizzi, G. "Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments"

Ceron, A., Negri, F., **Sangiovanni, S.** "What does it mean? A survey experiment on the efficacy of explaining the means to pursue a policy proposal"

Sangiovanni, S. "When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns"

Sangiovanni, S. "Economic Performance Indicators and Strategic Valence Choices"

Sangiovanni, S. "Who Cares About Valence Issues? Issue Priorities Among Voters of Valence Populist Parties"

Sangiovanni, S., Celebrin, G. "Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants' Satisfaction Across National and European Levels"

Taddei, F., **Sangiovanni, S.** "Just a Football match? Italian Terraces' Banners Analysis."

Sangiovanni, S. "Feeding the Cycle of Negativity: Exploring the Media's Influence on the Tone of Electoral Campaigns"

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Academic

Conference Organization Team Member

September 2023

ESPAnet 2023, University of Milan, Italy

Managed logistics for conference sessions and collaborated with colleagues in supervising students responsible for assisting conference attendees. Contributed to the preparation of conference materials and documentation

Research Assistant

October 2020 – December 2020

Global Media Monitoring Project, University of Milan-Bicocca, Italy

Collected and analyzed tweets from 7 Italian newspapers as part of the Global Media Monitoring Project, in collaboration with the Milano-Bicocca University research group. [Read the Italian GMMP 2020 Report](#)

Tutoring Online Project

October 2022 – March 2023

Bocconi University - Harvard University, Milan, Italy

Delivered over 40 hours of tutorship in Mathematics, English, and Italian to support students with financial and learning difficulties

Extra-Academic

Esports Caster – Content Creator

September 2014 – May 2018

Spaziogames, Milan, Italy

Created content and managed live streaming events via OBS Studio, provided live commentary for esports tournaments with over 10k concurrent viewers and wrote articles and reviews for the website

AWARDS, GRANTS & MEMBERSHIPS

2025 Visiting PhD [Fellowship](#), Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)

2025 MetRiSP Workshop Travel Grant, awarded by SISP, GPR, and ECPR's Standing Group on Political Methodology

2025 MZES-DVPW Conference Travel Grant for Early-Career Researchers, awarded by MZES

2023 Doctoral Scholarship. Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan

Memberships

Since 2025 European Political Science Society (EPSS)

Since 2024 Italian Political Science Association (SISP)

SKILLS

Languages

English (IELTS Academic Band 8, C1), Italian (native), Spanish (A2)

Programming Languages

R, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, SQL

Data Analysis Tools

STATA, Meta Content Library, Tableau, SPSS

Developer Tools

Git, GitHub, VisualStudio Code, Jupyter Notebook

Live Streaming Tools

OBS Studio, OBS Ninja, StreamElements

GIS Tools

QGIS